The Eternal Connection

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31640138.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F, F/M

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Part 1 of Twins of Eternity

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The Eternal Connection

by Bellcross

Summary

Adora has been having dreams. Dreams that she shouldn't be seeing. Dreams of her childhood. Of those who bore her. Of the one one who stole her. And of a baby... twins?!

Elsewhere, something dark awakens.

Notes

Sorry it's short. This is just the prologue! More will come!

See the end of the work for more notes

Prologue: Awakening

In the dark, a murmur stirred. It moved. And it's eyes snapped open.

"Hmm." It went. "My toy..." a voice, raspy from years of disuse spoke, "... was broken?"

"Heh...heh-heh... HA-HA-HA-HA-HA-HA-HA-HA-HA-HA-HA-HA!"

The laughter continued for some time, before it was reduced to an occasional snicker. "Well," the voice rang. It breathed deeply, trying to regain control of it's mirth. Though it took some time, it reigned itself in.

"I sense that old power of yours, D'Vann, old friend. But it's been so long since we've seen each other. And, unfortunately, you were mortal." the voice resounded, sounding almost sad.

"But," it began again, it's voice perking up almost cheerfully, "this means you had a child. Your descendants then. At least one."

There was a moment of silence. "No," the voice started, "The boy's potential is still untouched, but close. The girl, then."

The voice let out a low chuckle. "Aren't you happy, D'Vann? She put your forefather to peace. No one else did!"

There was another moment of silence. The voice broke it, murmuring. "She used so much power not her own. Astounding how powerful you're family is, isn't it?

"Honestly, you really keep the fight fun, even in death. I suppose that's how you beat me at all." The voice trailed off. "Ironic. A mortal gained enough power to defeat me, and your line keeps impeding me."

There was movement, and a massive, jet black claw raised itself up. Dark energy converged, forming a dark, glowing sphere. "But,

D'Vann, they should know. As long as I live, as does the true Horde."

Dark green veins pulsed with energy, and red eyes flashed.

"So says Horde Prime."

Just Dreams

Chapter Notes

Sorry for being late. I had to replace my laptop charger.

Please comment, as I would appreciate all feedback.

Adora saw only darkness. It was uneasy, and somewhat cold. She looked around, curious. "Hello?" she called out. But her voice went ignored. She wasn't afraid, she was simply confused.

The last thing she remembered was going to bed with Catra, and-

Adora facepalmed. "Ughhhhhhhhhhhh." she groaned. "I finished Horde Prime, I did my job, and I still have magic dreams?" she asked no one in particular. Adora shook her head. "Well, whatever, let's get this over wi-"

Before Adora could finish her sentence, she was pulled. Faster than she could handle, as if she was yanked off her feet. She went flying in a direction, but it seemed like everything had merged together.

Adora honestly couldn't tell if she was going up or down, left or right, forward or back. She couldn't see, so she squeezed her eyes shut. All she could tell was that the rush was cold, unfeeling. Like the dark given touch. But something in the direction she was pulled felt... different. Warm. Familiar? And like that, the cold pull disappeared.

Hesitant, Adora opened her eyes. And in the light she could make out... people. A man and a woman, huddling together. Standing over a crib. Curious, Adora looked into it. In the crib, she saw-

Adora bolted awake, knocking into Catra as she went, sending the startled magicat onto the ground. The former force captain groaned. “Seriously, Adora? Whyyyyy?” she moaned. Melog got up from their pad in the corner, nuzzling Catra lightly. She got up, stroking the cat’s head, her back to the bed. “I know we have plans, but you didn’t have to throw me out of bed first thing....”

To her surprise, Adora didn’t answer. Confused, Catra turned around to check on her girlfriend. The girl was wide eyed, staring straight ahead, but her eyes weren’t seeing anything there. The usually deep blue eyes were glowing with clear magic energy. Her hands laid on either side, trembling lightly. Her thoughts were gone to the world. Catra immediately moved to her side, shaking her.

“Hey, Adora! Adora!” she called, just a bit frantically. With that, the blonde girl snapped back to reality.

“Huh?” she started, her head whipping around to look at Catra. “Oh. Catra. Good morning.” She greeted her casually, smiling warmly. The startled Magicat received a loving kiss on the cheek.

Adora began to rise, but before she could fully leave the bed, Catra grabbed her wrist.

“Whoa, whoa, whoa, hold up there,” Catra started, pulling Adora back onto their bed. She let go of her hand, and cupped the girl's face. “What was that? Just now?”

Adora legitimately looked confused. “What was what?”

Catra shook her head. “You did the glowing eyes bit, Adora. That’s not usually a normal thing when you sleep.” she insisted. To this, Adora’s confused look intensified. She looked to the side, trying to remember…

Gently, she grasped Catra’s hands and held them. “I think it was just a dream. Nothing to worry about,” she said. And she meant it. When she had had magic dreams in the past, there was always a sense of exhaustion and panic when she woke up. It lingered too.

But this time, Adora felt refreshed. Somewhat… brighter. But Catra wasn’t convinced. “Okay, bruiser, then what did you dream about?” she almost snapped.

Adora's mood was, surprisingly, invincible. Simply, she shrugged, and patted Catra's shoulder. "Look," she began, "I appreciate the fact that you're worried about me. But it's okay! I feel… good. Just, really, really good."

Adora shot Catra another smile. "Trust me."

Catra's eyes darted from side to side, before staring into Adora's. The pure kind of insistence in her eyes was too much to resist. The cat girl sighed and nodded.

"Okay…" she huffed, and Adora smiled. She stood and stretched. "Okay then," she said, her smile becoming a little wider, " let's get ready for the vacation!"

At the table, Catra tentatively ate, while Adora scarfed anything she could get her hands on down as it was her last meal on Etheria. Though, to be fair, with their lives? There was a fairly good chance.

“Adora, Adora, slow down,” Bow insisted, a laugh bubbling up his throat as he watched his friend scarf down food. Glimmer giggled. “Well, we do have some experience with this particular munchfest, don’t we?

Micah himself chuckled with his daughter for a moment before speaking. “I hope you’re all excited for the trip to Mystacor. It should help you recharge those batteries! You deserve it after you all spent so much time fixing up the planet.

Catra guiltily looked down at her lap at that, having done a good deal of that damage. But Micah went on, undeterred.

“I know that last time it wasn’t… ideal…”

The man trailed off for a moment. Bow rubbed the back of his neck. Even Adora had stopped eating, the awkward atmosphere settling around the room.

Melog slept a little more at Catra's feet, having had its fill. Not that the magicat was jealous… but she was, a little. The cat-like creature could avoid a sensitive subject like this with the ability to be like an actual animal.

Catra looked up, and the tension was so strong, she was almost positive she could take the knife by her plate and literally cut it. She sighed. Former Force Captain to the rescue, *again* .

"So, Castaspella won't blast me when we get there, right?" she asked, a small smirk on her face. Everyone jumped a tad, all staring at her. Then, they burst out laughing.

Catra sighed in relief, leaning back in her chair. "Works every time," she thought to herself.

But while her friends laughed, she glanced at Adora- and stared. She knew her girlfriend wasn't being completely transparent with her. She could only hope that their vacation would help loosen her lips.

Mystacor.

After all that they'd been through, Catra honestly couldn't believe that they were going back to that place where Adora absorbed the thing that almost ripped her apart from the inside out with energy. But her girlfriend had insisted that it would be nice, so she'd relented.

But for the life of her, she had no real clue what she was doing in the steam grotto.

In fact… she couldn't even remember what plans she'd had

"Adora…" she moaned, almost miserable, "did you and Glimmer finally decide on how to kill me? Was Mermista a part of this water/heat death plan?"

She leaned on the edge of the tub, panting, her tongue lolling out. Bow and Glimmer were on the edges of the island with Melog, the fellow couple most likely napping or- Catra instantly slammed the brakes on that thought.

Adora chuckled. "Just relax, Catra. Breathe. It'll be okay, so long as you just find the right place to soak yourself."

Catra groaned as she waded into the water, feeling the varying heat. "Alright, alright," she groaned. "But don't expect any- oh." She found a pocket, just the perfect temperature for her. Adora

waded over to her, wrapping her arms around the furry girl. “See? Isn’t that ni-” The Princess of Power was cut off with a light snore.

She smiled as she held the sleeping magicat. “Not a bad idea,” Adora chuckled, “I’ll join you.”

Keeping a grip on her love, she leaned against the rim, letting herself soak…

Once again, Adora found herself in the black realm. This time, rather than being pulled, she walked towards the light. The light surrounded her, and one again, she was in the room with the crib.

Adora looked around, before seeing the man from before, sitting in a chair, holding a bundle in his arms. Tentatively, she made her way until she was standing right by him. Her breath caught when she looked in his arms.

A baby, with blue eyes looked at the man, staring at him with a curious gaze. Adora was silent- and in it, heard the man, heard… her father, with his deep, rich voice, one that reminded her of Angella’s majesty, spoke to the child. Spoke to her.

“I wish these moments could last,” he began, Adora behind him drinking in his every word, “But you will not be a child forever. The horrors of this world will come for you… And as your father, perhaps it will not be my duty to protect you, forever, but protect you until you can weather the storm on your own. Or perhaps I

will not. Perhaps you will lose me," his voice began to crack a little, "And perhaps, even more tragic… I may lose you."

Adora's heart pounded at his heavy words. As ignorant as she was, she knew her father was aware that a baby could not understand him. He just wanted it off his chest, but the pain in his words…

"But, " the man continued, "you and I, we are born to serve our people, our families. If I lose you, I will bleed, I will protect all of this world, in your name, little star, in the hopes that I may face you with pride when I pass."

Those words very nearly broke Adora's heart. Whenever she thought of her birth family, she thought of the Heart of Etheria, of Krytis. She thought them monsters, greedy tyrants. But this? This was proof otherwise. Proof that her family… Her birth family… Could accept....

Adora was snapped out of her thoughts by her fathers words, and she held onto each with rapt attention. "And I hope that if I pass before you, you will protect our family, or, if the heavens look upon you well, your own. I hope you do so valiantly, with the word of love not jest to your lips, like so many others. You may find that there will be those who besmirch the idea," he told her, "but no matter what, stand strong, little star. Stand strong."

Adora opened her mouth. She wanted to say something, but what? Would her father even hear her? She really didn't know.

Before she could say a word, she heard footsteps. She turned, and saw a woman. The same woman from before, but now that Adora could truly see her... She looked just like her mother. Except, she noticed, her eyes.

Her eyes were full of the weight she felt every day. Adora saw that every time she looked in the mirror. But her mother's eyes… They were similar. There was weight in them, but also a wisdom that lifted that. A mirth that powered through the grief and fear. A strength, Adora realized, must come with age.

"Not playing favorites, are you Randor?" Her lovely voice was like a bell to Adora. It was so… familiar.

But her words shook Adora a bit. What did she mean by "playing favorites"? She figured if she simply watched, she'd get her answer. So she waited.

Her father, (Randor, apparently,) turned to look at her mother. "Marlena!" he cried out, surprised. "I hadn't expected to see you so soon!" Adora, the baby, giggled at his odd outburst. And yet there seemed to be an… echo. Another laugh. Coming from…

Adora looked to see another bundle in her mother's (Marlena's) arms, identical to the one her father held. The bundle that held her. "Well," her mother said, "a slight giggle in her own voice, "Adam missed his twin."

Adora saw her mother hold the bundle, carefully, towards her father. Another baby, with near identical features stared at her younger self.

She blinked. A...twin? What's-

"...-Dora!"

Wait, whose voice was?...

"ADORA!"

Adora's eyes snapped open. She looked left and right, before blinking the shine from her eyes. But without warning, her face was yanked down, forcing her to look right into Catra's eyes.

"Adora! What's going on?!" she demanded. "You wouldn't wake up! You just floated there, holding me! What are you seeing?! Just tell me, please!"

Her fearful gaze shook Adora. Her love was hurting, she realized. She had to tell her, she had to-

“No,” something deep within her told her, “don’t do it. Don’t tell her yet. Wait to the end,” a voice whispered to her. “The dreams,” it stressed, “are not yet done…”

It seemed right to trust this voice, but she couldn’t leave things like this with Catra.

So she wouldn’t.

Gently, she removed her love’s hands from her face, and wrapped the magicat in a hug, pulling her head next to her own. “Catra,” she began, “I’m sorry I scared you. But you don’t have to worry. Nothing will hurt me from this.”

“But, Adora, you-”

“I know. I’m sorry I can’t tell you more. But Catra, even if they’re magic dreams, these are just dreams. They won’t hurt me.”

Catra gripped Adora, squeezing her tightly, as if afraid if he let go, the girl would simply disappear. “Promise?’

“I promise. For now? Just dreams.”

Alive

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Horde Prime shifted the energy in his clawed palm. He needed to be creative here. The girl had used energy from a weapon meant to kill him.

Hmmm. Death. He wondered if it would have worked. He shut his eyes, and watched from the eyes of the splinter, the former general. He looked back at the power of the girl… Adora was her name, if he recalled? Would that have been enough to end him, he wondered?

No, he instantly realized. They'd planned to use inferior magics. Sure, it would have destroyed the universe, or at least, most of it. But he would have remained. Eternia would have remained. Several galaxies would have remained. The collective power? A slap in the face. A testament to the old one's arrogance. Maybe if the forefathers had drained a few hundred more planets. But the paltry amount stored in Etheria?

Admittedly, he would have been injured, slightly. Like a scraped knee to a human But he was a being unlike any other. He was Entropy incarnate. The end itself.

He would simply have been hit, then devoured Etheria. Mara… She had interfered with that. She'd moved the planet into Despondos.

Horde Prime laughed. Mara was almost as entertaining as D'Vann. Sure, she hadn't fought him. But she had done something that no other mortal would have risked. And the cherry on top?

She hadn't known the real him. Just his cat's paw "Horde Prime". His plaything of her former general.

But she'd been too late to stop from getting a miniscule amount of his power there. He'd used it to corrupt a single woman- Light Spinner, if he recalled, but he couldn't really control it within. Not within Despondos. Even less when the girl arrived.

But that part was outside when it faded. Ironically, Light Spinner went out protecting Adora. But without the girl, Prime realized he could reach in now, within Despondos. Ordinarily, this would do little for him.

But with Etheria and the children of D'Vann on the brain, he had thought long and hard on his next step. Before, while he touched Despondos, he found something, someone, *alive* in a pocket, a Despondos within Despondos. He levitated the unconscious winged woman to his eye level. If Horde Prime could smile, he would. But he simply laughed again.

It was a good day.

Chapter End Notes

Please Comment for feedback!

Contact

Chapter Summary

Adora has questions, and a fairly crazy idea.

Adora and Catra walked briskly. Catra's face was full of worry, and she took glances at her girlfriend frequently.

In contrast, Adora's face was a sign of her constant thoughts, her mind racing a mile a minute. That look was combined with a look of sheer determination.

Adora had explained to Catra that she couldn't yet explain her dreams. She'd barely managed to reassure the girl's sheer panic, but this did not, Adora recognized, fully assuage Catra's fears. So, Adora sought to deal with her dreams, for both their sake, as quickly as possible.

Catra's issues, Adora had realized, were the result of fear of being abandoned by her. As things were, even Adora was clever enough to recognize that to Catra, it would feel as though her love was pulling away from her.

With their wounds so raw, Adora couldn't risk that. She couldn't lose Catra again, not after they fought so hard for their happiness. But first, she needed a question answered. And she saw just the person who could answer it.

“Castaspella!” Adora called out to the woman as she walked through the halls.

The dark-haired mystic halted in her tracks, smiling warmly at her young friend. “Ah, Adora! So, did you enjoy the Steam Grotto?”

Adora smiled. “Yes, thank you,” she started politely, before getting to the point.

“What’s a twin, if you don’t mind me asking, Castaspella?”

The older woman’s eyebrows raised. “Adora, why-”

“Please, Casta, I just…” Adora trailed off to glance at Catra. Castaspella’s eyes followed, seeing the magicat completely for the first time. A child, shuddering in fear. Adora turned back to look at the sorceress. “I just need... answers.” she continued, somewhat hesitant.

Castaspella looked back and forth between the two, before sighing. “Alright, Adora.” It was obvious that Adora was keeping things close to the chest. Castaspella could admit that she wasn’t always alert, but she could tell something was happening. But Adora wouldn’t, or couldn’t speak of it. So, she realized, all she could do was help the poor children who had been through all those two had.

“Twins are children, born to the same parents, on usually the same day. It could be two boys, two girls, or one of each,” the woman explained.

Adora’s eyes widened, and it was obvious- this new info had her mind running even faster than before. She turned, and grabbed Catra’s hand, before pulling her startled girlfriend down the hall.

“Thank you, Casta!” she called as she ran, “I’ll be back in just a minute!”

Elsewhere, Glimmer and Bow relaxed on the edge of the island, the clouds running up and down, like waves. Melog layed a bit further back, a tentative distance away from the clouds, but still close enough to help if need be.

Glimmer nuzzled into her boyfriend’s chest, before her eyes snapped open, half-lidded. She sighed, then spoke. “Bow?”

Bow hummed lightly, letting her know he was awake, and conscious of her words.

“Somethings about to happen. I don’t know if it's good or bad, but it's something.” she declared, beginning to sit up. Bow

followed suit reluctantly.

"Come on, Glimmer. What could happen right now that could be so important?"

Immediately, She-Ra landed heavily behind them, heavily, cradling a blushing Catra in her arms. "Glimmer, I need your help!"

The look Glimmer gave Bow had the force of a dozen unspoken 'I told you so's'.

"YOU WANT US TO WHAT?!"

Glimmer and Castaspella had heard some bad plans in their time. For Etheria's sake, they'd made some of those plans But what Adora had just suggested?

But the girl in question was a stubborn one.

"I want you to magically put me to sleep, until these dreams tell me everything," she explained again.

Castaspella put a hand to her forehead. "Adora, you don't understand what you're asking. You want us to keep you in a sleep for an indefinite period of time. *Without* knowing exactly when to wake you. Without that timing, if we keep you in that state for too long, you could be stuck like that, maybe forever."

Catra glanced at Adora as they both absorbed that information. She already knew what she was going to say.

"I understand that this will be risky. But I have to do this. I…" Adora trailed off, trying to figure out what to say.

Glimmer sighed. "Adora, maybe if you just told us why you want us to do this, we could help with a much better idea than a potential coma!"

Adora rubbed her face. "Glimmer, I would if I could! But-"

"Just do it."

Everyone whirled to look at Catra, all shocked. But the magicat simply rubbed Melog's head, not paying any mind to their faces.

"Look, much as I hate to say it, we need to do this. If Adora can figure something out, then we help her. Otherwise, she'll just…" Catra sighed, before chuckling lightly, and glancing at the girl in

question. “She’ll try it herself without us, and more than likely, get herself killed.”

She turned to Glimmer. “Look, I agree with you. This is crazy. But Adora’s asking for our help. At least with us, we can set some safeguards, keep her from actually going into a permasleep.”

Castaspella turned to look at Glimmer. As the Queen, she had the final say in this matter, and as Adora’s friend, her say would be doubly important. And her niece’s face scrunched up with frustration.

Glimmer rubbed her hands against her face and groaned. She felt a gentle hand on her shoulder, which she covered with her own. She looked to Bow, who smiled reassuringly over her shoulder. The young queen sighed before turning back to the friend who put her in this position.

“Four hours, Adora,” she insisted, “and that’s all I’m doing. Make whatever contact you need, in and out, am I understood?”

Adora nodded. “Thank you, Glimmer.”

Glimmer sighed again as she walked away, off to prepare.

“Don’t thank me yet…”

Plans

Horde Prime was… confused.

The winged woman he'd pulled from limbo… she was stronger than he'd thought.

Nowhere near his level, sure. But… Still, more powerful, more potent than your average planet's magic.

He'd earlier speculated that perhaps he'd underestimated Etheria while he inspected her. After all, it had existed before he had, though not by long.

But after going back on his work, and estimating the energy output based on what remained in this woman?

The resulting explosion would have been more damaging than he'd thought. Perhaps not killing, but he'd have been far more hurt than a mere slap. He'd overlooked something important.

Something *fun* .

He laughed.

First Eternia. Now Etheria.

The powers that be in the universe granted him a new force to play with. Though the Heart of Etheria on its own wouldn't have done too much damage, the item of interest that would have been destroyed in the process? That chain reaction would have been impressively destructive.

While it wouldn't have destroyed him, he would have been hurt. Sure, he would have recovered, but it would have taken some time, like his bout with D'Vann.

He was glad Mara had hidden it away. This way, the girl had powers, almost rivaling those of her ancestor- but she lacked skill in both combat, and pure manipulation of her abilities.

But now that the girl was connecting with her twin… he could see to it that she helped her brother come into his potential, and her brother would help her with her skill and fine control.

He looked at the woman. Angella, if her memories were accurate. He saw her daughter, Glimmer. Her potential wasn't as great as the heirs to D'Vann Grayskull's power, but her magical control was still intense. With some training, she could be one of the best.

And based on Angella's memories…

Oh yes. Horde Prime had big plans. And while the twins connected? He could start putting them all together.

He could hardly wait.

Skeletor

Chapter Summary

> Adora learns how she was taken to Etheria. She doesn't know how to deal.

Adora lied back on the bed in the center of the room, staring at the ceiling, shooting the occasional glances around the room, breathing as evenly as she could while Glimmer and Castaspella prepared the necessary ingredients for the spell.

Bow stood next to Catra and Melog in a corner. Catra was curled up, her arms hugging her knees, leaning into her bond. Catra glanced at Adora, who, in return, shot her girlfriend a reassuring smile. The magicat weakly reciprocated, but the moment Adora's eyes were no longer on her, her face fell. Deep down, while she had let this happen, she had severe reservations.

Without warning, Melog nuzzled Catra, and Bow put a hand on her shoulder, before giving her an attempt a comforting smile. But it was obvious that Catra gave her friends a small, grateful smile. Together, they watched the proceedings in silence.

Glimmer, on the hand, grumbled furiously. "I can't believe she's doing this," she complained to her aunt. Casta, however, knew what to say, but it was too soon. Knowing Glimmer, she knew her niece was hiding the biggest reason she was upset. But to figure out what that was, she needed her to speak her thoughts first, so she stayed silent, listening to every word her niece had to say.

“I know she has to protect everyone from something, but what’s the problem now?” Glimmer whispered. “I know she’s always doing something to sacrifice herself. And I know she hurts about things. But why is she doing this now?! We’re at peace! We don’t have to fight anymore! If we look for trouble…” Glimmer trailed off, her fist clenched.

Gently, Castaspella placed a hand on her niece’s shoulder. “Glimmer… I understand that you don’t want to see her get hurt anymore. But you’re not her. You can’t make choices for her, and just expect her to listen. As her friend, sometimes, you have to let someone go down a frightening path.” Glimmer’s face fell at that, the pain of hearing that apparent. But Casta went on.

“But this might be your way of making sure she doesn’t get hurt.”

Glimmer’s eyes rose, meeting her aunt’s. Casta smiled. “Like Catra said, you can best protect her by helping her, even if it’s foolish. And if anything goes wrong, we’re here to make sure that if the worst comes to pass, if Adora…” Casta stopped, her voice trembling slightly. Glimmer blinked. Her aunt was scared, too.

But the older sorcerer continued. “If Adora does fall into a coma, at least with us knowing the state she’s in, we can move her to Bright Moon, and try to bring her out of it.”

Glimmer shook her head. “But I don’t know if I’m strong enough to pull that off!” she pointed out. “That’s not… it hasn’t been done!”

Casta nodded. “I know this isn’t an easy choice. And your father’s strength should help fairly well, too. But as a team, and as a family, we will help Adora.” She gingerly placed her hand on Glimmer’s cheek. “Glimmer, I know when you see Adora, you don’t see a friend. You see a sister.”

Glimmer eyes widened, before she sighed. She shut her eyes, and inhaled deeply, before letting it all out slowly. “Okay,” she said, her eyes snapping open, “let's do this.”

Glimmer grabbed the ingredients, and charged them with her magic. In a flash of energy, the two sorcerers surrounded Adora with symbols and energy. The blonde swallowed nervously, but breathed evenly, as relaxed as she could.

The symbols and energy twisted into one, forming a needle that approached Adora’s face. Glimmer spoke up just before it came close to her head. “Remember, Adora. Four hours.” Adora looked at Glimmer.

Adora saw her friend, biting her lip, fear obvious on her face. Adora smiled at her kindly. “I understand, Glimmer.”

The queen’s bottom lip quivered, before she nodded, and she and Castaspella slowly lowered the needle into Adora’s head. And the moment it did, everything went dark.

Adora awoke directly in the bedroom. She glanced around, looking for her parents, but they weren't there. Her face curled with confusion- before she heard the tremendous BOOOOM!

In an instant, she whirled in it's direction, finding a window she hadn't seen before. She rushed to look out, high over… everything. But far from calmly taking in the view, Adora saw fires and explosions all around, hearing cries and screams. Of terror, and pain. Before Adora could lean in, she heard a door burst open.

She whirled, turning to see her father, fully decked out in battle armor. He was followed by two men in advanced silver, brown and green armor. In both of his arms, Adora saw, her eyes wide, he carried his children. And his face… she'd never seen such a furious visage on anyone.

Gingerly, he placed his children in the crib, before turning back to the men, one of them handing him a sword. Randor nodded his thanks, before he huffed. "You two," he began, "protect this room. Keep my children safe. Please. I…" He hesitated, the sword in his hand stiffening.

One of the guards moved, placing a hand on Randor's arm. "Sir, believe us, we understand. You have a duty to the people, as well as to your family. We'll look after them, till the end."

Adora’s jaw dropped. Her father had that much pure loyalty from his own people. It was good, better than she’d thought.

“No,” Randor commanded. “You will remain here until Man-at-Arms arrives. Upon which, you will locate my brother, assist my wife in aerial assault, and evacuate all civilians to the safe zone.”

The men looked at each other, then nodded to Adora’s father. The second man passed his helmet, which her father swiftly donned, giving the man a striking appearance. Randor nodded to the soldiers, before the three left the room.

Adora rushed to the door, glancing at the floor, seeing one shadow leaving, but two remaining on a faithful watch in front of the door. Her smile was so wide it almost hurt.

Her parents were heroes! They were good people! Their people had such faith and trust in them! This was a sign, right? A sign that the first ones who had performed such unforgivable actions were a thing of the past right?

But then the sounds of battle snapped her out of that thought. She rushed back to the window, watching. She saw battlements, explosions, and flashes of light she could have sworn were magic.

So, she realized, while her parents were good, not all followed that road. Many more were evil. And her parents fought them.

Adora pressed a hand to her chin. Maybe, she wondered, she could-

Her thought cut short as a hand emerged from the wall- or rather the shadows. With a violet energy, a hand emerged from the darkness. More and more of a large figure, almost the size of Randor emerged. A figure, in a dark violet cloak, wielding a ram-headed staff, emerged. Without a sound, he approached the crib.

Adora's breath caught, and she moved, placing herself in between the sinister being and the children. She looked up and glared- before her mind screamed with insane fear.

On his face, the man she was standing against wore a yellow, skeletal mask, the eyes glowing red dots. Adora remembered. This man- this living horror- she'd seen him. She'd seen this thing! Everything else faded away but that thing.

The thing walked straight *through* Adora, phasing through her. She turned, horrified, as the thing walked to the crib, and reached in and pulled out a child. Somehow, Adora knew exactly which child it had in it's claws.

Suddenly, the baby, Adora, opened her eyes- and she let out a piercing cry. Instantly, her cries were joined by her brother's

As soon as she did, a single man, large as her father, burst into the room, holding a large mace, coursing with white energy.

He spoke a single word with such venom, Adora knew immediately how bad this situation was.

"SKELETOR!"

Without an instance of hesitation, Skeletor leapt back from the crib, and his staff's ram head, coursing with sickly yellow energy, fired at her brother. The new man, who Adora could only assume was Man-At-Arms, leapt in the way, taking the powerful beam to the back, blowing away his heavy there, leaving a large hole, showing his scorched and burned flesh.

While this happened, Skeletor rushed to the shadows, leaping into them, and vanishing into the darkness.

Adora, shellshocked, suddenly found herself surrounded by worn down stone. She whirled, trying to figure out where she was, before she once again saw her parents. Both looked long since ragged, and more than a little upset.

"WHAT DO YOU MEAN WE CAN'T GET OUR DAUGHTER BACK?!" her mother screamed.

Adora whirled to see who she was yelling at, before her eyes widened. A beautiful woman with wings, wearing a ceremonial, bird-like attire stood before her parents, in front of the oldest throne Adora had seen.

The woman shut her eyes, and breathed deeply before speaking. “Lady Marlena, Sir Randor,” she said, calmly, respectfully, “I understand the severity of what I am asking of you. To allow your child to be in the hands of that monster.”

Adora was engrossed. This woman had asked them to abandon her? But… why? Why would she-

Without warning, as if time stopped, the woman looked directly at Adora… Before turning back to her parents. Adora, floored by this, simply watched and listened.

While her mother seethed with barely controlled rage, her father… he looked as strong as ever, still dressed in armor, run ragged, but not yet defeated, as she had been so many times. “Why, Sorceress, do you demand this of us?” he asked, his voice still strong.

The woman turned, and summoned a staff into her hand, before lifting it into the air. An image of the planet, Eternia, appeared, then expanded into a galaxy map- before being wiped away in a wave of powerful energy. Horrified, Randor and Marleena turned back to the Sorceress, looking for answers.

“Because of this. Your child is in the midst of being sent elsewhere, another planet in the universe. If your daughter remains, this universe itself shall take a heavy blow. Forces are acting to ignite an ancient weapon, and none but your daughter can stop it. If any other child were taken, much of this universe we reside in would be decimated.” she explained.

She turned to Marleena, who shouted once more. “But why her? Why our Adora?!” she demanded.

“Because she is special. The twins possess affinities that were passed through the ages. And the daughter is the one who must.” The Sorceress closed her eyes, biting her lip. “I… I truly am sorry. But to ensure this, I must erase her from the memories of all in Eternia until the time is right.”

Adora fell to her knees. She was taken to stop the Heart of Etheria? She was ripped away by an evil masked man… forgotten by all... to save everything?

“No.” Her father’s voice rang. Adora’s head whipped over to him, shocked. “No, we will not send my daughter, a child, to fix this. That is too much for her hands to bear! Why can I not go?” he demanded.

Adora tried to speak, to cry out, but her mind raced. So many emotions and thoughts of love and duty prevented her from

saying a word.

The Sorceress spoke up in response. “I’m afraid you don’t have the power, Randor, nor the affinity. If not her, all are doomed.”

“There must be another way!” he yelled, breaking his calm for the first time. “This is my child! I will not abandon her like this, and you-”

“Randor.”

To his and Adora’s surprise, Marlena had spoken up. Her face hidden by her hair, she spoke. “We have to.”

Adora felt her heart lift and drop, all at once. Randor, on the other hand, shot his wife a horrified look. “Marlenna, wha-”

“You hear her, don’t you? If another is taken, our daughter is still taken, by death. As is our son. As are our people, and millions of others. Innocent and guilty alike.”

Adora stared at her mother as the woman brushed her hair from her face, revealing heavy tears, streaming down her cheeks.

“Sorceress!” her mother yelled with strength and conviction. The winged woman looked Marleena in the eye, holding against the strength the blonde woman had there. “Will we see our daughter again?”

The other woman nodded. “If all goes well, you will see your child again.”

Marlena glared at the other woman. “I will hold you to that. If I cannot hold my child once more, before I prepare to pass… I assure you there will be a reckoning.”

Adora’s eyes widened at her mother’s… threat? No, somehow she could tell, this was a promise. Her mother would kill this woman.

The Sorceress, to her surprise, nodded. “I would expect nothing less.”

Randor walked forward. “In that case,” he began, “Allow myself, my wife, and Duncan to recall our child. To be able to help, to be with her as a family, and to truly take responsibility for this, we will remember. And she alone will have the choice to forgive us for our actions. For this.”

Adora’s mind raced. She didn’t know what to say, what . Before anything else, she was moved into the dark once again.

Games

Chapter Summary

> Horde Prime has a variety of plans, mixed with child-like excitement. Not a good look when his is a true overlord of evil.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Horde Prime had done well, if he could say so, himself. He had put many hours into it, but he now had three soldiers.

No, he corrected himself, toys. While they were partly his creations, they would not be loyal to him in the truest sense. Honestly, he really hoped they weren't. He was hoping, honestly, that they would rebel against him.

The struggle. The difficulty. That's what made things fun. That was why, despite the injuries D'Vann had left him with all those years ago, he favored that man. In fact, the injuries only made him more well liked.

Because the games were life and death. No matter who died, even himself, it was always such a thrill, putting everything on the line.

To Horde Prime, immortality was a blessing and a curse. He could play as long as he wanted, but he couldn't lose. He couldn't fail.

But D’Vann had hurt him. If the man had been more experienced, more practiced with his power…

Prime, in no way, considered losing. But the idea of losing? As he thought, a challenge made a fight worth it. And the twins… together, they would have the strength to battle him, after some tweaking. Challenges to grow for themselves.

The large being chuckled, before opening a window in space. On the other side, there was a large wall of rock. On one such, though oddly shaped, stone stone, the Horde symbol, gold, rather than black or red, was ahdorned, dead center.

Prime coursed energy to one of his fingers, before flicking it through the window. Steadily, it flew into his mark.

The rock course with power, cracks filling with that energy. Without any other warning, it burst apart- and out came a figure. A figure whose chest had the symbol of the Horde.

With booming footsteps, the figure walked steadily to the window, before kneeling.

“Lord Prime,” a gravelly voice spoke, strong and intelligent. “It has been too long.”

“Yes,” Prime agreed, “Yes, it has, Callix.”

The stone man looked up at his master. “What is your command, my lord?” he asked, eager to be put to work after years of stasis.

And, to his internal joy, his master had work.

“Go to Inferna. Gather your arms, and the Jar. I will give you more orders once these tasks are done. I must contact others in the meantime. Call for me once you are finished with this task.”

Callix nodded, but hesitated, just for a moment. But that was all Prime needed to see.

“Do you have a concern, Calix?” he asked.

The stone man swallowed, best he could. He knew his lord was fickle, and how… replaceable he was. In a manner of speaking.

“I do not mean to question you, Lord Prime,” he began, taking care to choose his words wisely, “but should I not release your brother, Lord Hordak, first? I had thought...”

Callix trailed off. He was nervous to the reaction of his master, having questioned his orders. He lowered his head, bracing himself for destruction- but it never came.

He looked up at his master, who was nodding in consideration.

"I understand your curiosity in my actions, Calix," Prime crooned, "but I assure you, it is with good reason I do this. You, perhaps better than any other, excluding myself, know my brother's nature, correct?"

Calix had to stop a chill from running down his back. Know Hordak's nature? Of course. He'd been killed by him so many times…

Horde Prime nodded, taking Calix's silence as confirmation.

"Exactly. My brother would rush things," he said, flourishing his arm. "Now go, prepare for the coming war," Prime commanded.

Calix banished his fear, and rose. "Yes, Lord Prime."

And with that, he leapt, reaching the stars swiftly, shooting off like a comet.

Prime closed the rift, before he chuckled lightly.

“Prepare, Children of Greyskull. Now, the games will truly begin.”

Chapter End Notes

For those wondering, Calix is a one-off character from the 2002 version of He-Man. He was killed by Hordak, so I added some details.

Inferna is a planet I made myself, and the Jar is as well. As fro what they are, you'll just have to wait and see!

Adam

Chapter Summary

Adora watches the end of her beginning- her ticket to Etheria.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora, still shellshocked from her recent discovery, came to another temple- this one far more familiar. To calm the disarray in her own heart, she leaned into that, leaned into the familiar. Just for the moment...

It looked much like the First One temple that she'd come to to see-

Light Hope.

"Light Hope!" Adora cried out, rushing forward, reaching out for her friend. She passed, straight through her, and fell onto her hands and knees.

But the A.I. paid her no mind, looking past her- as if she didn't exist. Adora's face fell. She was still in these dreams. She was still unable to help Light Hope, who, out of all her friends, might have needed her the most. Light Hope was more of a victim of First Ones than almost anyone, forced to be a tool of destruction, for a needlessly cruel goal?

Actually, now Adora was curious. Why did the first ones steal all the magic? To destroy Horde Prime? If that were the case, he would have been obliterated long ago… so, why?

A moment into her thoughts, she heard them. footsteps . She turned to look- and her blood ran cold.

The familiar mask. The one she'd seen earlier. The one that had abducted her.

Skeletor.

Adora tried to stand, but she slipped as she stood, and fell to her back. Sheer terror grasped at her heart. The fear surpassed what she'd felt for Horde Prime.

Horde Prime was frightening. She would admit that. His zeal, his voice, his… charisma, his need for control. All of those terrified her, though she would never admit the extent to her friends. But deep down, his vibe was cold, and mechanical.

But Skeletor? He was a completely different beast. She could feel his power. Dark. Twisted. She could hear screams of rage and hate from his very soul. His very being was fire, burning with pure animosity for just about everything.

She crawled backwards, before she stopped, swallowing. As afraid as she was, she knew- she had to watch this.

Light Hope was the first to speak. “Do you have what I asked for?”

Skeletor held up a bundle in his arms. “The child you requested. A girl. And…”

The man shifted Adora over to Light Hope, attempting to pass her over. “A one of a good heritage, as well. A descendant of the very first families of the Ancient Ones. Quite suitable for your needs, I would assume?” he asked her.

Light Hope nodded. “Yes. Quite.”

Adora noticed her glitch a bit, her form sparking. If Skeletor noticed, he said nothing.

“Well, that’s that, is it?” he inquired, before setting Baby Adora down, not really waiting for an answer. “Then have at it.” He turned, and waved at Light Hope, walking off, not looking back.

Adora, grateful for his exit, opted to simply watch Light Hope.

The A.I. knelt down, drawing her hand by Baby Adora's face.

"I… I am… sorry, little one. For all I must do."

She opened a portal- and Adora floated through.

All was dark, once again. Adora could feel the tears, running down her face.

Light Hope had been damaged for so long. Her parents had been forced to abandon her. She was scared of a man in a skull mask. A hate filled man.

The girl grit her teeth- before she roared out her feelings.

" **RAAAAAAAHHHHHHHHHHHHHHH!!!** "

Emptied of all those feelings, she fell to her knees.

But, without warning, a hand fell onto her shoulder, a form of assurance.

Adora looked up behind her, and saw a boy- one who looked very much like her.

“Adam?”

Chapter End Notes

Sorry for the late update. Things to do, here and there.

Apologies for the short chapter.

Trying again.

Chapter Summary

Canceling this story. Trying again. I apologize.

Hello everyone. I appreciate your feedback and patience, but I have decided to cancel this story, and try again. I had some plans, and I realized that it didn't really make sense with the flow. Thank you for reading, and please check out my other works when they arrive!

End Notes

A fanfic I wanted to make. Still a rookie. If anyone wants to help a bit, it would be appreciated.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!